TryHackMe Room Writeup 6 of 6

TryHackMe: Windows Fundamentals 2

Network Traffic Analysis, Nmap and Windows Logging | Week 2 | Lab Part

Room detail	Details
Platform	TryHackMe
Room	Windows Fundamentals 2
Room link	https://tryhackme.com/room/windowsfundamentals2x0x
Public profile	https://tryhackme.com/p/hariniedward
Status	Completed, 100%
About the room	Part 2 of the Windows Fundamentals module: System Configuration, UAC settings, resource monitoring, the Windows Registry and more.

Objective

The second part looks at the administrative tools that can be launched from System Configuration. The aim was to know what each tool shows, how to open it with a command, and which of them help when investigating a Windows machine.

What I learned

- System Configuration (msconfig) helps diagnose start up problems. It has General, Boot, Services, Startup and Tools tabs.
- Advanced system settings show the page file, which acts as extra virtual memory, and the Startup and Recovery options for the type of crash dump Windows saves.
- The UAC slider has four levels: Always notify, Notify for apps (the default), Notify without dimming, and Never notify.
- Computer Management (compmgmt) combines Task Scheduler, Event Viewer, Shared Folders, Local Users and Groups, Performance Monitor, Device Manager, Disk Management, Services and WMI Control.
- Shared Folders shows the shares on the machine, the current sessions and the open files.
- A service can start Automatic, Manual or Disabled, and its properties show the service name and the path of its program.
- System Information (msinfo32) shows hardware resources, components and the software environment, including environment variables.
- Resource Monitor (resmon) shows CPU, memory, disk and network use for each process.
- Command Prompt commands for quick checks: hostname, whoami, ipconfig, netstat and the net family of commands.
- The Registry Editor (regedit) opens the registry, the central database of settings for users, applications and hardware.

Tools and their commands

Tool	Command	Why it matters when investigating
System Configuration	msconfig	Boot, service and start up settings.
Computer Management	compmgmt.msc	One place for tasks, logs, shares, users and services.
System Information	msinfo32	Hardware, software and environment variables.
Resource Monitor	resmon	Links a process to its CPU, disk and network use.

Tool	Command	Why it matters when investigating
Registry Editor	regedit	Run keys and service entries are used for persistence.
UAC settings	UserAccountControlSettings	Shows how strictly elevation prompts are enforced.

The practical task

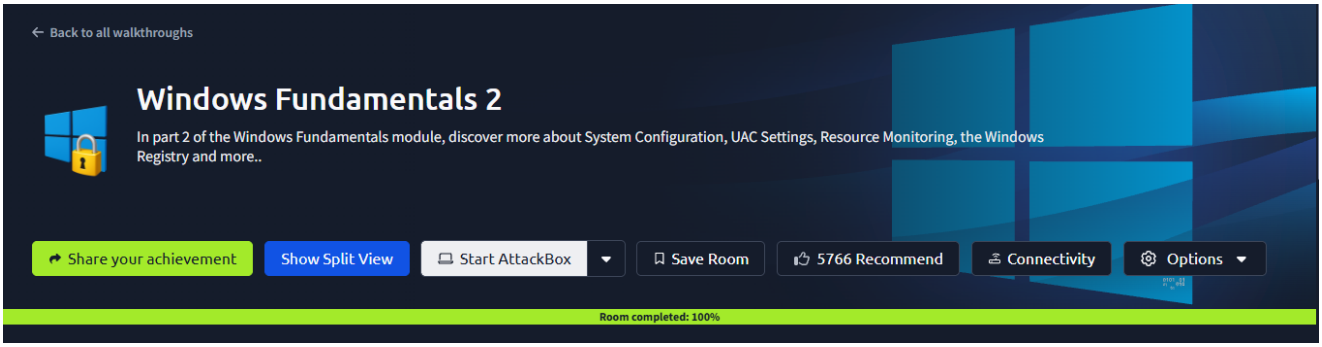
- Opened System Configuration and went through its tabs and the list of tools.
- Used Computer Management to look at scheduled tasks, shared folders, services and the other sections.
- Looked up the commands that open the Control Panel, User Account Control settings, System Information, Resource Monitor and the Registry Editor.
- Opened System Information and checked the system name and the environment variables.
- Used Command Prompt to run commands such as hostname, whoami and ipconfig.

Why this matters for a SOC analyst

- Event Viewer is where this week's Windows event IDs are recorded, so knowing where it sits and how it works is essential.
- Scheduled tasks, services, start up items and registry run keys are the usual places to check for persistence.
- Resource Monitor and netstat help connect a suspicious process to its network connections.

> **Key takeaway**
> These tools show where Windows keeps its configuration and its activity. Together with the event logs, they are the first places I will look when examining a host.

Completion proof



Room page showing 100% completion. My profile details have been removed from the screenshot.

References

Room: https://tryhackme.com/room/windowsfundamentals2x0x

My public profile: https://tryhackme.com/p/hariniedward